

AWAKENARTS

The Encounter Journal

A Self-Guided Companion to the Five Encounters

Susan Ann Shepler

*“Symbols do not explain.
They reveal.”*

How to Use This Journal

Every AwakenArts Encounter — met alone or with a facilitator — moves through the same four underlying movements. They are not a checklist, and they rarely arrive in a clean order. This journal simply gives you a quiet place to follow them, once for each of the five Encounters that open the AwakenArts Collection online at awakenarts.com/encounters.

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| 1 ENCOUNTER | Meeting the figure and the image before deciding what it means. |
| 2 RECOGNITION | The moment something here touches something true in your own life. |
| 3 REFLECTION | Putting language around what you've recognized. |
| 4 INTEGRATION | Letting what you've recognized change something, in its own time. |

You don't need to do anything with this map except keep it nearby as you go. Each Encounter below repeats the same four prompts — on purpose. The point isn't a new question every time; it's the same quiet attention, five times, on five different thresholds.

The five Encounters, in order: Journey, The Deep, The Table, The Word, Continue — though you're welcome to meet them out of order, or sit with any one of them more than once.

Journey

I begin.



Every journey begins before we know where it leads.

ENCOUNTER

What do you notice, before you explain it?

RECOGNITION

Has anything here caught you off guard?

REFLECTION

What's a sentence that wants to come out of this?

INTEGRATION

What might you carry with you?

The path continues into stiller water.

Continue this encounter — awakenarts.com/encounters/journey

The Deep

I encounter.



There are places within us that ordinary language cannot reach.

“Deep calls to deep at the roar of your waterfalls; all your waves and breakers have swept over me.”

Psalm 42:7

ENCOUNTER

What do you notice, before you explain it?

RECOGNITION

Has anything here caught you off guard?

REFLECTION

What’s a sentence that wants to come out of this?

INTEGRATION

What might you carry with you?

From the deep, a table is being prepared.

Continue this encounter — awakenarts.com/encounters/deep

The Table

I receive.



A place prepared for us often becomes the place where we begin to recognize ourselves.

“You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies...”

Psalm 23:5

“I sow my love with Heaven’s care...”

Angel Gardens

ENCOUNTER

What do you notice, before you explain it?

RECOGNITION

Has anything here caught you off guard?

REFLECTION

What’s a sentence that wants to come out of this?

INTEGRATION

What might you carry with you?

Welcome is followed by listening.

Continue this encounter — awakenarts.com/encounters/table

The Word

I listen.



Some words do more than inform us. They quietly become the language by which we learn to see.

“Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path.”

Psalm 119:105

“She gave a warning. You see what you believe.”

Swan Sings

ENCOUNTER

What do you notice, before you explain it?

RECOGNITION

Has anything here caught you off guard?

REFLECTION

What’s a sentence that wants to come out of this?

INTEGRATION

What might you carry with you?

The word heard becomes a way to walk.

Continue this encounter — awakenarts.com/encounters/word

Continue

I walk on.



Recognition is not a place to remain. It becomes a way to walk.

“The Lord will watch over your coming and going both now and forevermore.”

Psalm 121:8

ENCOUNTER

What do you notice, before you explain it?

RECOGNITION

Has anything here caught you off guard?

REFLECTION

What’s a sentence that wants to come out of this?

INTEGRATION

What might you carry with you?

Continue exploring these themes through the AwakenArts Collection.

Continue this encounter — awakenarts.com/encounters/continue

Continue

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Visit awakenarts.com/collection

If this way of meeting a symbol resonated with you, *The AwakenArts Guide to Symbolic Facilitation* goes further — for facilitators, group leaders, and anyone who wants to companion others through this same practice.

Find it at awakenarts.com

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